How the Lakers Provide Value Through Social Media: Case Study

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The Los Angeles Lakers have done an incredible job in marketing their brand, image, and mission on social media. The Lakers have a vast presence on popular online platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, and YouTube, especially in 2021 when they recorded “185.6 million engagements across these four networks – this was 20 million more than the next highest team, the Golden State Warriors” (Carp, 2021, p1). Currently far and above any other US sports franchise with 63.8 million followers across Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, X, and YouTube (Feldman, 2025, p1), the Lakers connect their fans with the pride of being in big market city marked by success and fame. Utilizing social media to represent the royalty, the achieving, and the luxury tradition of Los Angeles helps to spread the pride and prestige of the city while also connecting the fans to live real-game experiences as they occur.

The demand for constant updates and insider access in the sports entertainment world has created the need for sports organizations to display information and news to their audience as it occurs live. The Lakers build on their reputation of championship success through stardom, fan loyalty, and a competitive-edged attitude demonstrated through hard work and grit. The history and excellence of the Lakers organization have fostered a fanbase that has spanned many decades, along with experiencing lots of growth and progression. The images and news social media can display across widespread networks delivers moments in time that can give insight to the organization’s past, present, and future actions. When a team reaches the point where they have a vast social media network that reaches their target audience, it is important to expand that even further. This would include providing behind the scenes content, engaging directly with the audience, and including your mission statement or core values (Cortes Ellendt, 2024, p1). A team with an established social media presence can optimize fan experience

through direct engagement opportunities to tell a story of the organization as its history progresses. The personal and emotional storytelling aspect of the Lakers that fans can relate to through social media interactions will also drive a fan to stay loyal and devoted to the team.

How does this Lakers brand continue to keep fans entertained before and after games, as well as during the offseason? If an avid sports fan is going to deem a franchise as supportable, they expect news, engagement, and information about the organization continuously. The Lakers have personalized reporting coverage from Mike Turddell (Spectrum SportsNet), Jovan Buha (The Athletic), and Ryan Ward (Lakers Nation). Furthermore, they continue to personalize events by hosting "Camp Lakers, a basketball camp committed to providing young players with the ultimate Lakers experience by discovering the important of hard work and dedication" (Whitaker, 2025, p1). The ability of the Lakers to keep the loyal supporters of their franchise involved all year long with personalized information and experiences helps them retain and increase their fanbase over time. Providing insider access and direct engagement experiences demonstrates the individual aspect of greatness – one that only fans of such a prestigious and historic franchise get to associate with. The Lakers have one of the most established and loyal fanbases and are incredibly effective in reaching consumers – many statistics drive a franchise, such as media revenues, profits from games, and merchandise (Damodaran, 2013, p9). In order to optimize social media performance, the Lakers should tailor their events to increase to the maximum amount of direct fan engagement. This can be done through reaching out to older time Lakers legends and having them connect with newer popular culture stars to drive community outreach and attract as many loyal fans as possible to the historically excellent Lakers fanbase.

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